

Activity Guide — senior / module-01- what-is-iks

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Primary Source Reading

Module: What is IKS? (Senior) · **Day:** 2 · **Time:** 30 min within Day 2

Goal

Students read Ṛg Veda 1.1 and Īśa Upaniṣad opening in IAST with word-by-word gloss.

Materials

- Printed handout (provided)

Instructions

Part 1: Ṛg Veda 1.1 (12 min)

Read silently. Then aloud (don't worry about perfect pronunciation).

Word-by-word with partner — match Sanskrit to gloss.

Answer: What is the speaker doing? What is the social context (priest, sacrifice)?

Part 2: Īśa Upaniṣad opening (12 min)

Same process. Read silently → aloud → word-by-word.

Answer: How is the tone different from Ṛg 1.1? What philosophical move does the verse make?

Discussion (6 min)

Pair share: “What surprised me about reading these in IAST.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read 5 more verses of Īśa Upaniṣad after class. Discuss tomorrow.
- **Tier down:** Skip the IAST pronunciation; focus on the meaning.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 1 (Senior)

Type: 5–6 page research paper · **Marks:** 65 · **Due:** Day 10

Topic options

Choose one or propose:

1. **Pick ONE specific Indian intellectual achievement** (Mādhava’s series, Aryabhata’s rotation, Pāṇini’s grammar, Sushruta’s surgery, the Nyāya theory of pramāṇas, etc.). Articulate what it established, what it didn’t, and why it matters today.
2. **The policy question** — argue a position on NEP §4.6 IKS integration, steel-manning the other two positions.
3. **A comparative study** — pick a specific question (e.g. “the development of zero”) and compare the Indian, Greek, Chinese, and Arab traditions.
4. **The boundary question** — argue for a specific definition of “IKS.” Defend the boundary choice.

Required elements

- Clear thesis in opening paragraph.
- ≥1 primary source (verse, theorem, named text).
- ≥1 scholarly secondary source (Plofker, Pollock, Wujastyk, Cardona, Olivelle, Matilal).
- ≥1 comparative or policy source.
- A steel-manned counter-argument with response.
- Works-cited in MLA or Chicago.

Format

- 5–6 pages, double-spaced, 12pt.
- Title page with name, class, thesis.

Schedule

- Day 7: topic chosen.
- Day 8: outline.
- Day 9: draft.
- Day 10: paper submitted.

Rubric

See `rubric.md`.

Self-reflection

In 4–5 sentences: 1. Topic + why. 2. Most challenging aspect. 3. What you'd research deeper with 3 more days.